

Practice Paper 2 — Answer Scheme

Paper 2 — Comprehension

Sections B & C

Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

Q1. [2] — Grandfather's manner of giving instructions

1 mark for identifying that he is **quiet** / **gentle** in tone rather than loud or harsh.

1 mark for noting that he is nevertheless **firm** / expects **complete obedience** — his softness is a sign of authority, not weakness.

Sample answer: The grandfather does not raise his voice; instead, he speaks **gently and quietly**, but the narrator understands that this calm tone is precisely when he is **most serious** and expects to be **obeyed without argument**.

Q2. [2] — “A small but important treaty”

1 mark for understanding that a **treaty** implies a **formal, mutual agreement** between two parties.

1 mark for explaining that this suggests the moment marks the **beginning of a new, more serious relationship** between teacher and pupil — both have committed to the lesson.

Accept: it suggests **mutual respect** / a quiet but binding promise.

Q3. [2] — Ingredients as a surgeon's instruments

1 mark — **Precision and order:** like a surgeon, the grandfather has arranged each ingredient **deliberately** and **in its own dish**.

1 mark — **Seriousness / expertise:** the comparison shows that cooking, for him, is a **skilled, careful craft**, not a casual activity; he treats it with the **concentration of a professional**.

Q4. [2] — Tilting his head like an old teacher

1 mark — He prefers to teach by **making the pupil think for herself** rather than by giving direct answers.

1 mark — The comparison suggests he wishes his granddaughter to **work out the reason** on her own, which will make the lesson **stay with her**. (Also accept: he is gently patient and slightly amused by her impatience.)

Q5. [1] — “Hurried meat is bitter meat”

1 mark: If you try to cook the meat **too quickly**, the result will be **unpleasant in flavour**; good cooking — and, by extension, good work — **cannot be rushed**.

Q6. [2] — Two ways the kitchen feels calm

1 mark each for any two of:

- The steam rises in “shy ribbons” — a gentle, slow image.
- The smell “wrapped itself around the ceiling fan and slipped under the door” — suggesting a slow, peaceful spreading.
- The grandfather “sat down on a low wooden stool” and **did not stir** or **lift the lid** — emphasising stillness.
- He watches the pot “with the calm, absorbed attention of a man watching a slow river”.
- The instruction “Sitting is part of the recipe” makes calmness itself an ingredient.

Q7. [3] — Difference between narrator’s learning and grandfather’s cooking (language question)

1 mark for identifying the **contrast** — modern, measured, recorded learning versus instinctive, sensory cooking.

1 mark each for **two** clearly quoted and explained details (max 2).

Accept any two of:

- “no measurements... no timers... no recipe card” — the listing emphasises the **absence** of the structured tools the narrator expects.
- He cooks “by smell, by the colour of the broth, by the depth of a sound when a spoon tapped the side of the pot” — the **tricolon of senses** shows that his knowledge is **embodied**, not written.
- “This much. Sometimes a little more, if the weather is wet” — the imprecise, intuitive measurement contrasts with the narrator’s wish for clean instructions.
- “I wrote that down in my head, knowing already that it would be useless to anyone but me” — the narrator realises that this kind of knowledge **cannot be transferred in words**.

Each detail must be **quoted** and **explained**; mere lifting without explanation = ½ mark.

Q8. [2] — “A thought one keeps returning to”

(a) [1]: **Simile** (or accept **metaphor** / **comparison**) — the taste is compared to a thought.

(b) [1]: It suggests the peppery warmth is **not immediate or aggressive**, but **lingers in the mind** / **memory** — quiet at first, then increasingly present, like a thought one cannot let go of.

Q9. [1] — Impression from “Acceptable”

1 mark — Any **one** of: he is **understated** / **reserved** / **undemonstrative**; he is **sparing with praise** / expresses approval through **quiet restraint**; he does not want to **embarrass her** with open praise, even though we see from the previous sentence that he is in fact pleased.

Q10. [1] — Why the narrator did not know what to say

1 mark — Any **one** of: she is **moved** / **surprised** by his quiet vulnerability; she realises she has **taken his patience for granted**; she feels a **small guilt** that no one asked sooner, and silence is the only honest response.

Q11. [1] — Tone of the final paragraph

1 mark — Any **one** of: **reflective, tender, nostalgic, grateful, affectionate, wistful**. (Reject: **sad, regretful** — these miss the warmth.)

Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

Q12. [2] — Inverted commas around “polite”

1 mark for identifying that the inverted commas **distance the writer from the word** / signal that it should not be taken at face value.

1 mark for explaining the implication: the writer suggests the critics were being **diplomatic rather than enthusiastic** — the verdict was actually **underwhelming**, but the critics softened their judgement out of courtesy.

Q13. [1] — Original burger’s expense

1 mark — The patty had cost “more than a quarter of a million euros” to produce. (Accept any equivalent reference to the €250,000 figure / the implied scale of investment.)

Q14. [2] — How cultivated meat is made (own words)

1 mark for the **source of the cells**: a small biopsy / sample of cells is taken, often painlessly, from a living animal.

1 mark for the **growing process**: the cells are placed in a steel container (bioreactor) filled with a special nutrient liquid, where, under controlled conditions, they multiply and develop into muscle fibres — that is, meat.

Reject answers that lift the phrase “bioreactor: a steel vessel filled with a nutrient broth” without rewording.

Q15. [2] — Two environmental harms of livestock farming

1 mark each for any two of:

- It produces around **fourteen per cent** of all human-caused **greenhouse gas emissions**.
- It uses **nearly a third** of the planet’s **ice-free land**.
- It is **one of the largest drivers of deforestation** in the tropics.
- (Implied) it consumes very large quantities of water.

Q16. [1] — The “more immediate moral promise”

1 mark: That billions of farm animals — particularly chickens (around seventy billion a year) — would **no longer need to be killed** to satisfy human appetite for meat. Accept any answer that clearly identifies the **reduction of animal slaughter / suffering** as the moral promise.

Q17. [2] — Contrast in Paragraph 4

1 mark for identifying the **contrast**: the cleanness and morality **claimed** by supporters versus the **less flattering reality** the writer presents.

1 mark for **two** supporting details (one mark, must include both):

- The “nutrient broth” depended on **foetal bovine serum** — taken from **unborn calves** — so an “animal-free” meat in fact relied on an **animal product**.

- The bioreactors use **enormous amounts of electricity**, which, in countries powered by coal or gas, can make cultivated meat **no cleaner — and possibly dirtier** — than the chicken it replaces.

Q18. [2] — “Farmers replaced by engineers”

1 mark for understanding the **literal** shift: meat production would move out of the **countryside / farms** and into **industrial laboratories or factories**.

1 mark for the deeper concern: a worry about the **loss of traditional rural livelihoods, communities and skills** — and about food being made by **technicians** rather than people with a **direct relationship to animals and land**.

Q19. [1] — Effect of “fierce”

1 mark: It suggests the disagreement is **intense, emotional and bitter** — not a polite difference of opinion, but a **heated, possibly hostile** dispute. (Also accept: it hints at strong commercial and cultural interests on each side.)

Q20. [1] — Tone of “still a decade away”

1 mark — Any **one** of: **sober, realistic, measured, cautiously sceptical**. (Reject: **pessimistic, hopeless** — these overstate the writer’s position.)

Q21. [2] — “Neither a miracle nor a fraud”

1 mark — **Parallel / balanced phrasing**: the two opposing extremes (miracle / fraud) are placed side by side and **both rejected**, which makes the writer’s middle position feel **fair and considered**.

1 mark — It **resists hype on both sides**: cultivated meat is neither the **saviour** its enthusiasts claim nor the **con** its critics suspect — the writer signals an **honest, evidence-based view**.

Q22. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]

Content points (½ mark each, max 6 marks). **Eight available content points; candidates should aim for all 8.**

Benefits supporters claim (Paragraphs 3–4):

1. It could **cut greenhouse gas emissions** from meat production.
2. It could **reduce the land needed for meat** by more than ninety per cent, freeing farmland to be returned to forest.
3. It could **lower water use** in food production.
4. It would **avoid the slaughter** of huge numbers of farm animals each year.

Concerns people still have (Paragraphs 4–6):

5. Until recently the growing medium required **animal-derived foetal bovine serum**, undermining the “animal-free” claim.
6. Bioreactors use **large amounts of electricity**, which, in fossil-fuel-powered countries, can make the process **no cleaner than conventional meat**.
7. Most **consumers are reluctant to try it**; many find it “unnatural” or distrust food grown in tanks; some fear the loss of **farming livelihoods**.

8. It remains **very expensive**; **price parity** with ordinary meat is still around a **decade away**, and investment in the industry has slowed.

Sample full-marks summary (78 words):

Supporters argue that cultivated meat could sharply reduce greenhouse gases, free up huge amounts of farmland, save water, and spare billions of animals from slaughter. Yet doubts remain. Early growing fluids depended on an animal product, and the energy-hungry tanks may, in coal-powered countries, pollute as much as ordinary meat. Most consumers find the idea unnatural and worry about farmers losing work. The product is also still costly, and matching supermarket prices is years away.

Length count: 78 words from “Supporters” onwards.

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —